

TOF CONTENT SOP

GOH CONSULTING

Goal

Give you the complete process to create top of funnel content that stops strangers, earns the watch, and wins the follow, so you build the one thing every brand needs: attention.

TOF stands for top of funnel: the content a total stranger sees first, before they know you, your offer, or your results. (Later stages are MOF and BOF, middle and bottom of funnel, where you qualify and sell.)

What this is

Top of funnel content is content built for one job only: to get the right people to stop scrolling, watch, and follow your account. It is not built to sell, to qualify leads, to explain your offer, or to show your results. If your TOF content is trying to do those things, it is costing you reach and, in the end, leads.

You get that reach by creating curiosity, through open loops and broad hooks, so the algorithm pushes your video to more people, and more of your ideal audience comes with them.

The one rule this whole SOP hangs off

Go as broad as possible without being irrelevant.

Open the video to everyone, then narrow to your ICP as it plays. The stranger has to be able to stop and watch before your ideal client ever knows the video was built for them.

ICP means ideal client profile, the specific person you actually want to work with. The trap most people fall into is writing the whole video for that person from the first second. The fix is to lead broad and let the ICP recognise themselves later.

The test to run on every video: if the algorithm pushed this to 100 strangers who had no idea who you were, how many would stop and watch? That number is set almost entirely by your hook, and it decides everything that happens next.

Why it matters

The secret to an amazing brand is influence. If nobody is watching you, everything else you have built is wasted. The biggest names in any space can sell almost anything because people bought into *them* first, then bought whatever vehicle they were selling.

The gut check: if you switched offers tomorrow, or sold hats with just your logo and mission on them, could you still sell out? If the answer is no, you are over-reliant on your offer and you need to make people fall in love with who you are. That is what TOF content is for.

Bonus: get this right once and it compounds. The hardest thing in content is landing that first genuinely strong video. Once you have one, you can reverse engineer it into an almost endless run of ideas (covered in the process below).

Example (threaded through this SOP): my "I flew 14 hours to surprise my family" video. It opens on my family screaming while I climb out of a box, says nothing about business for the first half, and sits at over 800,000 views (close to a million). I come back to this one video at every step below, because it shows the whole method working at once: a broad hook, an open loop, a narrow-to-ICP turn, real emotion, and a pain point I later spun into a dozen more videos.

When to use this

Use it for every piece of organic short form content whose job is reach: reels, shorts, and TOF carousels. Use it after your visual identity and your communication are already dialled in, because a broad hook still needs conviction and a strong first impression to land (those are the earlier modules, and they are the cause behind this effect).

When not to use it: do not use TOF rules on content whose job is to qualify or sell. And accept the trade-off up front: there is no organic strategy that attracts only qualified leads. If you are not willing to make content that non-ICP viewers also enjoy, do not do organic.

Who owns it

You, the creator, own the idea, the hook, and the emotion. Nobody can reverse engineer your life for you.

Your editor owns the execution of the packaging once you have briefed it. If you track numbers closely, a data or analytics lead can own the metrics side (internally that is

Aiden's job, so send hard-metric questions there). Everything in this SOP can still be run solo.

Before you start

Dialled-in visual identity and communication from the earlier modules. Packaging is downstream of how you look and speak on camera.

Your Dream Follower Worksheet. This is the internal document where you defined your ICP in detail. You will mine it for pain points. (Internal resource, see Gaps to confirm.)

A way to capture moments the instant they happen (see Edge cases for the exact setup).

An editor plus a briefing system, so the packaging in your head actually makes it into the edit.

The process, step by step

The engine has five moves: understand the job, use open loops, build the broad-to narrow hook, engineer emotion, and reverse engineer your winners into more content. Package everything so the idea actually lands.

Step 1: Lock in the one job of TOF content

Goal: stop trying to do everything in one video.

Say it out loud before you write: this video exists to get a stranger to stop, watch, and follow. That is it. The moment a TOF video tries to sell, qualify, explain the offer, or flex results, it narrows too fast, strangers scroll, and the algorithm buries it.

Why this matters mechanically: when you post, the platform shows the video to about

10% of your audience first. If they do not like, comment, or watch, it flags the video as weak, cuts your reach, and stops showing it to new people, so you do not grow. If engagement and retention are high, it pushes to another 20% plus non-followers, that drives more engagement, and the loop repeats until you are at 100,000 views or wherever it lands. Your job at TOF is simply to win that first 10%.

Step 2: Build open loops

Goal: create enough curiosity in the first five seconds that scrolling past feels uncomfortable.

An open loop is curiosity by design. It runs on a fixed three-part

chain: Introduction → Delay → Resolve

Introduction: open a question, a mystery, or tension.

Delay: withhold the payoff or the resolution.

Resolve: close the loop later in the video, or deliberately keep it open.

This is why unpredictable creators dominate. With Speed, you are watching to see what he will do next. With Mr Beast, you are watching to see who wins the challenge. You cannot predict the payoff, so you keep watching to close the loop, and the satisfaction pulls you back next time. If you are not getting views or steady new followers, you are almost always not building enough curiosity.

The trap: running the same format and the same concept over and over. Your audience already knows what you will say, so there is no loop to close. Combat predictability by testing new formats and new ideas. The lie detector video worked precisely because no one in the space had seen it, so the whole video became one big open loop.

The example in action: the surprise video opens on people screaming and me climbing out of a box. Within five seconds your brain is asking "why are they screaming, why is he in a box?" That is the introduction and delay. The reveal at the end, me surprising my family, is the resolve.

Step 3: Write the broad-to-narrow hook

Goal: stop the maximum number of people while still making your ICP feel it was made for them.

The single most important concept in TOF content is that your hook should be as broad as possible without being irrelevant. The structure is always the same shape:

First 1 to 3 sentences (broad): plain, simple, general language anyone can answer or feel. No industry words yet.

Around 15 to 20 seconds in (narrowing): introduce your ICP's language and buzzwords (for business it is words like leverage, inputs, workflow, data).

Middle to end (ICP): now it feels made specifically for your ideal client.

Structure the script itself in three sections: TOF (broad), MOF (turning toward the ICP), BOF (fully speaking their language). Non-ICP viewers will drop off partway through, and that is completely fine. They already did their job: they gave the algorithm the engagement that carried your video to your ICP, who stay for the whole thing and feel like you made it just for them.

Two hooks, same insight, opposite results:

Broad win: "How many of you work on Sundays?" Almost anyone over 20 can answer it, so it pulled in a wide audience and did 40,000 views, even though the real message underneath was niche business advice about leverage and inputs.

Niche flop: "If you're not booking calls from your content..." Of 100 strangers shown that, maybe 3 are coaches struggling to book calls. The other 97 scroll instantly, the platform flags it as weak, and it dies.

The example in action: the surprise video says nothing about business for the first half. "Surprise" is something everyone relates to. Only halfway through do I mention wanting to stay in London for business before choosing family, which is the moment the business owner in the audience feels spoken to. The broad hook bought the reach; the mid-video turn delivered the ICP.

Step 4: Engineer the emotion

Goal: make the viewer feel something, because content that creates no emotion does not get shared, saved, or pushed.

Before you finish any piece of content, ask: which emotion am I creating? If you cannot answer clearly, rewrite it until you can. Four emotions drive the most engagement:

Inspiration: "I want to live like that" or "that's possible for me."

Curiosity: "I need to know how this ends" or "I've never heard it framed that way." Validation: "that's exactly what I've been feeling" or "finally someone said it." Urgency: "I need to change something now" or "this is costing me more than I realised."

Show, do not tell. There are already a hundred million videos a day telling people what to do. Instead of telling, show yourself doing the thing, then talk. Do not say "here's how I manage my team," show yourself confronting an underperforming editor. That editor confrontation video stacked three emotions at once (curiosity, tension, and the frustration every business owner knows) and did 50,000 to 60,000 views with 3,500 likes, because a stranger wanted to know why the guy was being scolded, while the business owner saw their own life on screen.

The example in action: the surprise video hits curiosity in the hook, then validation in the middle (prioritising family over business). That mix is also what made me likable, not just watchable, which is the real payoff of TOF: people who share your morals think "this guy is sick," save it, and want to work with you.

Step 5: Reverse engineer your winners

Goal: never stare at a blank page again. Turn one strong video into an almost endless list of ideas.

Stop trying to invent content ideas. Start reverse engineering the emotions and insights that already worked. The named drill is ask why three times:

1. Take your best-performing piece (strong engagement, lots of DMs, or actual leads, not just view count).
2. Ask "why did it perform?" three times, past the surface, until you hit the underlying emotion. For the editor video: it built curiosity, because there was tension, because it was a real business moment that was not going smoothly.
3. From that core emotion, brainstorm 10 new ideas that create the same feeling through completely different angles.

One pain point, infinite ideas. The surprise video's core emotion was parental validation, huge in Asian culture and a pillar of my brand. From that single pain point: how my mum's opinion of me changed, how I felt when my dad stopped questioning my decisions, how it felt sending money to my parents, buying them gifts, proving the doubters wrong, growing up being told this path was not real. None of those videos look like the original, but each carries the same power.

To find your own pillars, go back to your Dream Follower Worksheet and list the pain points that also resonate with the general public. Mine are three: making family proud, work-life balance, and making more money.

Step 6: Package it so the idea actually lands

Goal: protect the video from dying in the edit. Packaging is the number one thing to

get right, before the content itself.

Packaging is the title, the on-screen text, the background music, the emotional beats, the conviction in your delivery, and your visual identity, all working together. The same footage can hit 20,000 views or a million depending on it.

Deliver from the right emotional state and with real conviction. My "\$10k a month is the new minimum wage" video flopped because I did not believe it: I smirked, stuttered, filmed on a plain white background with bad lighting. If I had said something I actually believed, with conviction, good lighting, and a city-view background, it could have performed ten times better. Only make content you genuinely believe.

Ask of every edit: is the editing helping this video or taking away from it? On the "my mum's live reaction to me making 150k a month at 19" video, the slow instrumental under the build and the upbeat guitar on the reveal were both intentional, and they were the difference between 20,000 views and a million.

Three ways to make sure the packaging in your head reaches your editor (use them together):

1. Record a 1 to 2 minute Loom per video (Loom is a quick screen-and-voice recording tool). Spell out the title hook, the music feel, and the exact emotion on each beat.
Pros: fastest way to kill variables on a single important video. Cons: you do it every time.
2. Build format SOPs and a music library the editor rotates through. Big brands run 8 to 10 fixed formats, each with its editing style and background music documented, which is why they produce so easily.
Pros: scales, less room for error. Cons: upfront work to build.
3. Score ideas before you film them. Run an ideation scoring system (for example, will this get 100k views, pre-selling power, proven concept, ICP resonance, stakes, on brand) and only produce ideas above a rising threshold, starting around 75 and climbing.
Pros: trains you and your team to raise the bar every week. Cons: self-scoring is rough until you refine it.

What good looks like

A strong TOF video passes the TOF Test, and you should be able to answer all three before posting:

What pain point does it hit?

Does it appeal to a wide audience? (Yes / No)

Does it build curiosity within five seconds? (Yes / No)

Beyond the test: the hook is broad enough for a stranger yet turns to your ICP mid-video, there is a clear open loop in the first five seconds, you can name the single emotion it creates, you are showing rather than telling, and the packaging (title, music, delivery, background) is intentional. Even middle of funnel pieces should clear this bar, or almost no one sees them.

Common mistakes

Putting the niche hook first. Why it hurts: 97 of 100 strangers scroll, the platform flags the video, reach dies. Instead: lead with a line anyone can answer, narrow later.

Using ICP buzzwords in the first sentences. Why it hurts: you signal "this isn't for you" to the broad audience that would have carried your reach. Instead: plain language first, buzzwords after about 15 to 20 seconds.

Telling instead of showing. Why it hurts: it is boring, only niche, and replicable by anyone. Instead: show yourself doing the thing, then talk.

Ignoring packaging and dumping raw footage on the editor to "cook something up." Why it hurts: an untrained editor cannot read your intent, so a potential million-view video lands at 20,000. Instead: brief the title, music, and emotion (Loom, format SOPs, or both).

Saying things you do not believe for views. Why it hurts: the lack of conviction shows on camera and the video falls flat, like the \$10k minimum wage flop. Instead: only make content you genuinely believe, delivered from the right emotional state.

Posting replicable montages. Why it hurts: a plain "me working" montage invokes no emotion and anyone could make it, so it flops. Instead: add a creative layer only you could pull off.

Trying to invent ideas from scratch. Why it hurts: you burn out and stall. Instead: reverse engineer a winner with the ask-why-three-times drill.

Edge cases and exceptions

Carousels. The script and structure stay the same, just delivered as text and visuals.

Rip your best hook straight into text format.

On-screen text hooks. Same rule as the spoken hook: as broad as possible while still making the ICP care. Tie a broad flex to a curiosity point, for example "how I bought a \$2m car at 19 for my mum" rather than a flat "buying a \$2.4m car."

Watch-through metrics. You do not need to chase a specific percentage. The working gut test is: would a nine-to-fiver or a six-figure earner care up to this point, and would my ICP watch the whole thing? If you are numbers-driven, take exact watch-through questions to your analytics lead.

A great unplanned moment happens. Keep capture friction near zero. Keep cameras on tripods permanently set up where you work (key light already positioned) so you can film the instant flow hits. A MagSafe phone tripod is a fast, cheap alternative, and worst case, film it on your phone's back camera, because capturing it beats losing it.

Your idea list is mostly B2B. Separate B2B from B2C and cut the B2B-only items for TOF, since they will not travel to a broad audience.

"Anyone could rip this idea." Filter it: if someone copied it, would their version be as outstanding as yours? Win by being first to bring a format over from another industry, or by adding a creative layer (a match-cut transition, a lie detector) so a copy just looks like they are copying you.

Things to note

Packaging beats script. Even average words land if the packaging and positioning are strong. The lie detector for a refund video, with lighting and someone off-camera asking the hard question, beat any talking-head version of the same point. Go the extra mile, treat content as an art.

Make what only you can make. The strongest TOF pieces are the ones no one else could create. Ask "what can I talk about that nobody else can?" and tie it back to making yourself likable.

Buy into you before the offer. Influence is the asset. Build a brand people would follow even if you changed what you sold.

The first winner is the hard part. Landing one genuinely strong video is the whole battle. After that, reverse engineering does the heavy lifting, so document and record constantly to catch the real moments.

Quick checklist

Run this before you post any TOF piece. Aim for every box ticked.

The TOF Test

- ☐ Can I name the pain point this hits?
- ☐ Does it appeal to a wide audience, not just my ICP?
- ☐ Does it build curiosity within the first five seconds?

Hook and structure

- ☐ Are my first 1 to 3 sentences broad and free of industry buzzwords? ☐ Does the video narrow to my ICP around 15 to 20 seconds in?
- ☐ Is there a clear open loop (Introduction, Delay, Resolve) up top?

Emotion and delivery

- ☐ Can I name the single emotion this creates (inspiration, curiosity, validation, or urgency)?
- ☐ Am I showing rather than telling?
- ☐ Do I actually believe this, and am I delivering it with conviction?

Packaging

- ☐ Is the title or text hook strong enough to stop a stranger?
- ☐ Is the music chosen to match the emotional beats?
- ☐ Have I briefed the editor (Loom or format SOP) so the packaging survives the

edit? This week's actionables

- ☐ Have I written 5 TOF hooks, each answerable by anyone, not just my ICP? ☐ Have I taken my best video and asked "why" three times to reach the core emotion? ☐ Have I brainstormed 10 new ideas that create that same emotion through different angles?
- ☐ Have I filmed one TOF piece and scored it on the Emotion Test before posting?

Gaps to confirm

Referenced in the source but needing a human to confirm before this SOP is handed out:

Dream Follower Worksheet. Attach the current version and access, since Step 5

depends on it. Internal.

Ideation scoring system. Confirm the exact scoring criteria, the current threshold, and where the template lives. It was described as self-scoring for now, with an AI scored version planned. Internal.

Tools. Confirm the current stack referenced for revisions and briefing: Frame (review), Whisperflow (voice-to-text feedback), and Loom. Internal.

Background music library. A format-by-format music and editing SOP was said to live in Notion. Attach it. Internal.

Hook review. Best hooks are reviewed live by the founder in the community lounge and general chat. Confirm the current process and timing. Internal. View and like counts quoted here (surprise video 800k plus, Sunday hook 40k, editor video 50k to 60k with 3.5k likes, mum reaction video near 1m, paycheck video, lie detector 30k) are the founder's recollections. Verify against analytics before publishing exact figures.